

Uk Student Visa

- Study in the UK
- Student visas for courses, degrees and independent schools
- Find the right study visa
- Check if you need a UK visa
- Types of study visa
- Student visa
- Child Student visa
- Study English in the UK (Short-term study visa)
- Visit the UK as a Standard Visitor
- Sponsors and sponsorship
- Students: if your education provider loses their sponsor licence
- UK visa sponsorship management system
- You can apply for a Student visa to study in the UK if you're 16 or over and you:
 - have been offered a place on a course by a licensed student sponsor
 - have enough money to support yourself and pay for your course - the amount will vary depending on your circumstances
 - can speak, read, write and understand English
 - have consent from your parents if you're 16 or 17 - you'll need evidence of this when you apply
- If you're 16 or 17 and you want to study at an independent school in the UK, you may be eligible for a Child Student visa instead.
- This visa has replaced the Tier 4 (General) student visa.
- When to apply
 - When you can apply depends on whether you're applying from inside or outside the UK.
 - Applying from outside the UK
 - The earliest you can apply for a visa is 6 months before you start your course.
 - Applying from inside the UK
 - The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.
- You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin within 28 days of your current visa expiring.
- How long it takes to get a decision
 - You'll usually get a decision on your visa within:
 - 3 weeks, if you're outside the UK
 - 8 weeks, if you're inside the UK
 - You may be able to pay to get a faster decision - you'll be told if you can when you apply.
- How long you can stay

- How long you can stay depends on the length of your course and what study you've already completed in the UK.
- If you're 18 or over and your course is at degree level, you can usually stay in the UK for up to 5 years. If it's below degree level, you can usually stay in the UK for up to 2 years.
- Read the guidance to find out exactly how long you can stay.
- Staying longer in the UK
- You may be able to:
 - extend your visa if you're eligible, for example to continue your studies in the UK
 - switch to a Student visa from another visa if you're already in the UK
 - switch to a Graduate visa
- A Graduate visa will allow you to stay in the UK after successfully completing your course for:
 - 2 years if you apply on or before 31 December 2026
 - 18 months if you apply on or after 1 January 2027
- It will allow you to stay for 3 years if you completed a PhD or other doctoral qualification.
- When you can travel to the UK
- You can arrive before your course starts. This can be either:
 - up to 1 week before, if your course lasts 6 months or less
 - up to 1 month before, if your course lasts more than 6 months
- You must not travel to the UK before the start date given on your visa, no matter when your course starts.
- Fees
- It costs:
 - £524 to apply for a Student visa from outside the UK
 - £524 to extend or switch to a Student visa from inside the UK
- You must pay the visa fee for each person that joins you.
- Healthcare surcharge
- You'll also have to pay the healthcare surcharge as part of your application.
- How much you pay depends on how long your visa lasts.
- Your partner and children
- You may be able to bring your partner and children ('dependants').
- What you can and cannot do
- You can:
 - study
 - work as a student union sabbatical officer
- You may be able to work - how much depends on what you're studying and whether you're working in or out of term-time.
- You cannot:
 - claim public funds (benefits) and pensions
 - work in certain jobs, for example as a professional sports person or sports coach

- be self-employed
- study at an academy or a local authority-funded school (also known as a maintained school)
- If your application is successful, you'll be told what you can and cannot do on a Student visa.
- Documents you'll need to apply
- When you apply for your Student visa you must provide:
 - a current passport or other valid travel documentation
 - a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS) from your course provider
- You may also need to provide:
 - proof you have enough money to support yourself and pay for your course - this will vary depending on your circumstances
 - a valid ATAS certificate if your course and nationality require it
 - proof of parental or other legal guardian consent if you're under 18
 - proof of your relationship to your parent or guardian if you're under 18
 - your tuberculosis test results
 - written consent for your application from your financial sponsor if you've received sponsorship for your course fees and living costs in the last 12 months
- You may need to provide additional documents depending on your circumstances. Read the guidance for the full list of documents you'll need to provide.
- If you're under 18
 - If you're under 18 you'll need written consent from both parents or legal guardians (or one parent if they have sole responsibility).
 - This must include their consent for:
 - your visa application
 - your living and care arrangements in the UK
 - your travel to the UK
 - You'll also need to provide a copy of your birth certificate (or another government issued document) that shows the names of your parents.
- FAQ
- What is the procedure for applying for a student visa?